

Calendar of Forthcoming Electronics Fairs/Exhibitions/Seminars/Events

Name, Date and Venue	Topics to be covered	Contact address for details
Hybridica 2012 November 13-16, 2012 New Munich Trade Fair Centre, Munich, Germany	Third international trade fair for the development and manufacture of hybrid components and lightweight hybrid solutions	Indo-German Chambers of Commerce Maker Towers E, 1st Floor Cuffe Parade Mumbai 400005 Fax: (022) 66652120, Phone: 66652127 E-mail: munchfair@indo-german.com Web: www.indo-german.com ; www.messe-muenchen.de
electronica Munich 2012 November 13-16, 2012 New Munich Trade Fair Centre	International trade fair for electronic components, systems and applications	MMI India Pvt Ltd Lalari Aura, 5th Floor, 34th Road, Khar (West), Mumbai 400052 Fax: (022) 42554719, Phone: 42554723 Web: www.mmi-india.in ; www.electronica.de

Look up under 'Events' section in www.electronicsforu.com for a comprehensive list

Since this information is subject to change, all those interested are advised to ascertain the details from the organisers before making any commitment.

Supreme Court quashes all 122 2G licences

Supreme Court has revoked all 122 telecom licences allotted under the 2G spectrum allocation on or after January 10, 2008 during the tenure of former telecom minister A. Raja. While giving the verdict, the court ruled that 85 out of the 122 licences were outside the eligibility criteria for allocation and all the 122 licences for 2G spectrum were granted in arbitrary and unconstitutional manner.

While cancelling the licences, the apex court said that the licences will be cancelled in four months and the Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) must go in for a fresh issue of licences during this period. Supreme Court further imposed a penalty of Rs 50 million on Unitech Wireless, Swan Telecom and Tata Telecom, while Loop, S-Tel, Allianz and Sistema Shyam have to bear a penalty of Rs 5,000,000

Around 10,000 telecom jobs may get impacted due to the verdict. The most affected areas are likely to be telecom sales, customer support, and tower management and maintenance.

Many engineering colleges to shut down

A research report from Credit Rating and Information Services of India Ltd (CRISIL) agency suggests that a large number of engineering colleges are expected to shut down or merge with better colleges. The low occupancy rate in engineering colleges makes it difficult for them to sustain, forcing them to either face closure or collaborate with other colleges.

The institutes are not able to operate efficiently. Between 2006-07 and 2011-12, the number of seats at AICTE-approved engineering colleges increased to 1,485,000. This sudden outburst of seats led to decline in aver-

age occupancy level in 2011-12 to 67 per cent.

Akash Deep Jyoti, head, CRISIL Ratings, said, "It is a major concern as India has a large number of engineering colleges and every year million of students graduate from these colleges. But these students lack the required skills and in-depth knowledge about the subject. This has created an urgent need for the re-establishment of such colleges to rectify the quality scale in the corporate sector."

India's first electronics manufacturing cluster soon

In an attempt to accelerate investments in high value-added electronics manufacturing in the country, ELCINA Electronic Industries Association of India is coming up with electronics manufacturing clusters in different parts of the country. ELCINA has joined hands with Vittal Innovation City for developing these clusters.

The first model cluster, consisting largely of SMEs to manufacture electronic components and products for the consumer electronics, power electronics and lighting industry, is expected to come up in north India, near national capital region in one year. It will involve participation of the members interested in investing in setting up facilities in this area. Each cluster will attract investment of up to Rs 10 billion and create over 15,000 direct jobs.

New telecom policy for telcos

The government of India has released the New Telecom Policy (NTP), which will simplify mergers and ease out licensing rules. However, these rules will be applicable only to those who have 3G spectrum licence.

Kapil Sibal, telecom minister, said, "The prescribed limit on the spectrum assigned to a service provider will be 2x8 MHz (paired spectrum) for GSM technology for all service areas other than Delhi and Mumbai, where it will be 2x10 MHz (paired spectrum)."

This means that it will be easy to

Awards

Epson wins six product design awards

Epson's product design has been recognised by iF Product Design Awards 2012.



Products across Epson's range were selected for this year's award including its business projectors, and label, receipt, airline boarding pass, retail and photo printers. These products will now carry the coveted iF logo in certain geographies.